

BORDERLESS KENYA · PAYAZA × HACKHOUSE NAIROBI · TRACK #03 — SME & EXPORTER COLLECTIONS

kusanya.

Kiswahili · *to collect, to gather*

Get paid for what you ship — wherever your buyer is.

Invoice-first international collections for Kenyan SME exporters. AI turns a WhatsApp order into a professional invoice · buyers pay in USD by card or Apple/Google Pay · KES settles to M-Pesa with total transparency — all on Payaza rails.

USD → KES live

KES ⇄ UGX / TZS momo

TypeSafe Jev AI

shadcn/ui · Next.js

Wanjiru loses 3–8% of every invoice. And waits a week for it.

The challenge's named persona: *"Small exporters in agriculture, crafts and digital services struggle to collect from international buyers without expensive intermediaries."*

PERSONA

Wanjiru · FreshLeaf Exports

Murang'a → Nairobi. Aggregates French beans & macadamia from **40 smallholders**.

- › 30–60 orders / month, USD 800–6,000 each
- › Buyers in Dubai, London, Amsterdam
- › Mid-range Android · lives in WhatsApp
- › M-Pesa + KES bank account · no global PSP

Her week, today

- › Orders arrive as WhatsApp voice notes & photos; invoices typed in Word
- › Buyer pays by SWIFT wire — USD 25–45 + intermediary deductions — or refuses for small amounts
- › PayPal route: multi-day holds + ~5% withdrawal loss via third parties
- › Bank converts at its own opaque rate on arrival
- › Forwarding agent's commission paid by hand

What it costs

- › She pays smallholders **before** she collects → bridge loans at 3–8%/month
- › Quotes padded "just in case" FX moves → **lost orders**
- › Hours of admin + "where is my payment?" anxiety, **every week**
- › At USD 30k/month, 4% leakage = **USD 1,200 / month** — more than this hackathon's prize, every month

3–8%

of invoice value lost to fees, spreads & FX
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3–10 days

invoice-to-cash float, every order

weekly

"the person who feels it every week"

Every option trades speed, cost, or dignity.

None of them owns the exporter's actual workflow: invoice → collection → conversion → settlement → partner splits → follow-up.

SWIFT bank wires

USD 25-45 + 3-7 days

Intermediary deductions nobody can predict, paperwork, and buyers under USD 2,000 often refuse to wire at all. The bank's arrival FX rate is opaque.

PayPal · Wise · Payoneer

~5% + withdrawal holds

Kenya withdrawal friction (multi-day holds, third-party services), **no M-Pesa-native settlement**, no EAC mobile money, invoicing built for Western freelancers — not Murang'a aggregators.

Bank merchant acquiring

paperwork wall

Requires documentation informal SMEs don't have; onboarding takes weeks; Stripe doesn't serve Kenya-registered SMEs natively. The intermediaries the challenge names.

Generic PSP checkout pages

acceptance ≠ workflow

A pay button solves acceptance only. No AI invoicing from WhatsApp, no transparency on FX, no agent splits, no settlement ETAs, no risk/compliance trail — the exporter still does everything by hand.

The gap: a product that owns the whole exporter workflow — and rides licensed rails instead of reinventing them. That's Kusanya.

WhatsApp in. KES on M-Pesa out.

Four steps, one mobile-first flow — AI does the paperwork, Payaza moves the money.

STEP 1 • SNAP / PASTE

AI invoice from the order itself

"Please send 500kg French beans to Dubai Fresh Co, attn Susan, we'll pay USD 2.30/kg as usual"

Jev extracts buyer, items, amounts, currency, due date — **low-confidence fields highlighted** with the source snippet, one-tap fixes. Numbers resolved in code; the model never invents an amount.

STEP 2 • SEND & COLLECT

Buyer pays in 2 minutes, zero signup

INVOICE KSN-2026-0042
Dubai Fresh Co. LLC · due 03 Oct

USD 1,150.00

Pay securely — Payaza

Intl buyers: **card · Apple Pay · Google Pay** (hosted checkout / payment link).
EAC buyers: **M-Pesa · MTN · Vodacom** momo prompt in KES/UGX/TZS.

STEP 3 • SETTLE TRANSPARENTLY

KES to M-Pesa, honest math

Gross	USD 1,150.00
Payaza fee 1.9%	-21.85
FX 128.9 (locked)	→ KES
Agent split 3%	-34.50
Net · M-Pesa by Thu 16:00	KES 140,113

Webhook flips PAID → payout via Payaza transfers. **Every fee itemized, real settlement ETA** (T+1 local, T+3–5 USD — Payaza's actual SLAs, not theater).

STEP 4 • PARTNERS AUTO-PAID

Splits & follow-ups, hands-free

Otieno · forwarding agent ✓ paid at settlement
Reminder to buyer AI draft → day 3 approved

Agents & co-ops registered as **Payaza split-settlement beneficiaries** — their cut lands automatically with statement lines. Past-due invoices get guard-railed reminders (AI drafts, Wanjiru approves).

Built on Payaza rails — structurally, not bolted on.

Eight product areas carry the flow. Remove Payaza and Kusanya doesn't exist. Nothing is mocked.

Rail map

Web Checkout SDK	hosted modal — intl buyers pay USD by card / Apple Pay / Google Pay	in
Payment Links	no-code hosted pay pages on invoices (USD/KES)	in
MoMo collections	KES (M-Pesa, Airtel) · UGX (MTN, Airtel) · TZS (Vodacom, Airtel, Tigo, Halopesa)	in
Transfers / payouts	KES → M-Pesa (mobile_money) & bank (kepss) · UGX/TZS momo	out
Split Settlements	agents & co-ops paid automatically at settlement (SSA_codes)	out
Webhooks + status APIs	HMAC-SHA512 verified events drive the ledger state machine	truth
Subscriptions	Kusanya Pro (KES 1,500/mo) billed on Payaza's own rail	SaaS
Refunds · Bank Codes · Account APIs	buyer refunds, payout setup, live wallet balances	ops

Corridors in scope

WORLD → NBO · USD → KES	demo live
NBO → KLA · KES → UGX	enabled
NBO → DAR · KES → TZS	enabled
NBO → KGL · KES → RWF	Payaza roadmap*

*Honesty slide: Payaza's public docs ship no RWF rail today — we don't mock it. Rwanda switches on when the rail lands.

Integration discipline (from 57 doc pages + the OpenAPI spec):
Payaza <base64-key> auth, per-API header matrix, webhook-as-truth with client callbacks treated as hints, unique references + dedupe (Payaza never retries — we own idempotency), split-value semantics handled correctly (it's the platform's keep, not the beneficiary's).

Not a chatbot. Calibrated decisions inside the payment pipeline.

Jev returns typed answers with probabilities — code owns the workflow, the model supplies programmable common sense. Every judgment is logged and merchant-visible.

1 • EXTRACTION

WhatsApp → invoice

One batched call: buyer Choice, amount/currency selection from **code-extracted candidates**, firm-order Noul, quality Score. Dates & numbers resolved deterministically — zero hallucinated amounts.

2 • RISK COMPOSITE

Screen every invoice

Batched Noul — sanctions language, amount anomaly vs buyer history, first-buyer, jurisdiction, name mismatch — weighted **in code** → pass / review / hold with reason chips + probabilities.

3 • INTENT ROUTING

Buyer replies, handled

Promise-to-pay / dispute / question / spam classified and routed into the follow-up engine; low confidence → merchant sees the raw message. No lost context, no wrong auto-replies.

4 • GUARDRAILS

AI drafts, human sends

Every drafted reminder passes an unsafe-claims Noul + per-claim citation check against ledger facts before the merchant approves it. Nothing auto-sends to a buyer.

Audit trail by design. State, criteria, probabilities and overrides persisted per judgment — the screen a Payaza compliance officer can pilot against.

Fail-safe, never fail-open. AI unavailable → manual form prefilled with regex guesses; new buyers default to review. Money flows even if Jev doesn't.

Economics that work. Batched System-One calls cost < **USD 0.01 / invoice** — viable at SME ticket sizes where per-token LLMs aren't.

Half her leakage is our entire take rate.

Pricing sells itself against the status quo: Kusanya keeps 1.5% where wires, PayPal and spreads take 3–8%.

Revenue

- › **1.5% take rate** on collected volume (rail fees passed through at cost)
- › **Kusanya Pro** — KES 1,500/mo: subscriptions billing, multi-user, accounting exports, WhatsApp bot — *billed on Payaza Subscriptions*
- › **0.25%** on auto-split volume — agents pay for certainty
- › Later: FX-transparency premium tier · Payaza Boost lending referrals from clean ledgers

Unit economics · per USD 1,000 invoice

Buyer-side rail cost (intl card)	– USD 29*
KES momo payout	– USD 0.30
Jev AI judgments (batched)	< USD 0.01
Infra + notifications	– USD 0.05
Kusanya revenue	USD 15.00

Exporter saves vs status quo USD 10–50 + 2–9 days

*pass-through at commercial rates; exact Payaza fees displayed live in the transparency panel — we never hide behind the spread.

Market & GTM

- › Beachhead: ~50k Kenyan SME exporters¹ · 1% penetration ≈ **USD 50M TPV / USD 750k ARR**
- › **Pilot first:** 5–10 merchants from Payaza's own network (10k+ Storefront merchants already sell online)
- › **Agent-led growth:** every forwarding agent onboarded as a split beneficiary brings their exporter book
- › Communities: KEPA events, agri co-ops, craft associations, Hackhouse alumni · WhatsApp-native distribution (sharing an invoice = sharing the product)

¹ estimates from public trade/freelance data (World Bank, KNBS, provider fee schedules) — pilot data replaces them; sources in repo docs/research.md §7.

A pilot in months — because Payaza holds the licenses.

Kusanya is a workflow layer on regulated rails: no custody, no license of our own, no PCI scope. That's what makes "feasible within a few months" honest.

Regulatory posture

- › Payments run on **Payaza's licensed infrastructure** (CBN & Bank of Ghana licensed; Kenya rails live in their docs) — funds never touch our servers
- › **PCI-DSS scope avoided by design:** card data enters only Payaza's hosted checkout — we never see a PAN
- › KYC tiers mirror Payaza's own test/live gate: Tier 1 (phone/email + ID, small limits) → Tier 2 (KYB docs, full limits)

AML & data protection

- › Jev composite risk screening on every invoice + **immutable audit trail** (state, criteria, probabilities, overrides)
- › Hard holds on high-probability sanctions hits; human escalation; sender blocks populated on every payout per Payaza AML fields
- › Kenya DPA 2019 posture: PII minimized, encrypted, exportable/deletable; demo fixtures are synthetic personas only

Engineering reliability

- › Next.js 15 + TypeScript strict + **shadcn/ui** + Postgres/Drizzle — one Vercel deploy, webhook URL live day one
- › **Webhook is truth:** HMAC-SHA512-verified events drive a typed state machine; client callbacks are hints; polling + cron reconciliation cover webhook gaps
- › Idempotency everywhere: unique references, dedupe indexes, no automatic double-payouts; integer minor-unit money math

Demo-day proof

- › Built against Payaza **sandbox from day one:** test cards (3DS + non-3DS), momo test-funding endpoint, test payment links
- › **Demo Mode:** recorded real sandbox payloads replayed through the same pipeline — the 4-minute judge demo never depends on venue Wi-Fi
- › Playwright demo-path regression suite must stay green to ship

What we're asking for. What Payaza gets.

The prize we're actually building toward: the structured pilot conversation with real Payaza merchants.

FROM PAYAZA

- › **10 pilot merchants** from your network with export flows — Storefront sellers already shipping abroad are ideal
- › **Kenya/EAC sandbox enablement:** test-mode KES/UGX/TZS momo collections (the docs' on-request gate) + test phone numbers
- › Commercial **fee schedule** so the transparency panel shows real numbers from day one
- › Confirmation: **split settlements with KES beneficiaries** (else we run the payout-leg fallback — already designed)
- › Mentor hours at Hackhouse during the build phase; KYB fast-track for live keys post-event

PAYAZA GETS

- › A **vertical product activating six of your product areas** (checkout, links, momo, transfers, splits, subscriptions) for a new merchant segment
- › **Incremental cross-border TPV** on the exact corridors this hackathon targets — USD→KES and EAC momo
- › **Fraud-screened volume:** calibrated risk judgments + audit trails on every invoice, aligned with your published fraud taxonomy
- › A **Kenya-expansion case study** and community goodwill at Hackhouse Nairobi
- › Subscription-rail dogfooding: Kusanya Pro is billed on Payaza Subscriptions

90-day pilot success metrics

TPV collected via Payaza rails	≥2% leakage saved vs prior method	≤ T+4 median time-to-KES	≥90% AI extraction fields untouched	0 compliance incidents
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Real rails. Real webhooks. Four minutes.

BEAT 1

Paste a real WhatsApp order text → **Jev extracts the invoice live** → fix one amber field with a tap

BEAT 2

Buyer laptop (London persona): invoice page → **Payaza hosted checkout** → test card through 3DS → receipt

BEAT 3

Flip to merchant app: **webhook lands live** → PAID → toast + SMS on the phone mirror

BEAT 4

Transparency panel walkthrough → OTP-confirmed KES payout to M-Pesa (sandbox-funded) → "Imefika!" receipt

BEAT 5

Agent **split statement line** + the REVIEW-state invoice with reason chips and AI audit log

BEAT 6

Business case in three numbers + the ask: **10 pilot merchants**. Close on the corridor map.

Tuma invoice, lipwa leo.

Send the invoice. Get paid today. – kusanya.

Eugene Mutembei • Washington Adiadio • Jael Nyambura – Team Kusanya • Nairobi

USD→KES live

KES⇌UGX

KES⇌TZS

RWF next